the persons concerned in the present conspiracy, but was one of the most important revolutionists'. Where the tribunal was not unanimous was on the matter of whether he should be put to death. Two of the three members of the tribunal sentenced him to death, but the third member 'did not think a capital sentence called for, and the sentence was eventually commuted by the Viceroy to transportation for life'.[9] Spared from the hangman's noose, like the Russian novelist Fyodor Dostoevsky, Bhai Parmanand was instead given deportation for life in the Andaman Islands. From there his luck only improved. He was released after just five years in 1920. Upon his return to the mainland, he was in 1921 astonishingly appointed chancellor when National College joined the Punjab Quami Vidyapeeth. With his background in history from King's College London, he was the one who taught history to the students at National College. Using his firebrand style, he relished expostulating the role of revolutions in the democratic development of Europe. [10]

Then there was Principal Chhabil Das. He was born in 1900 and went on to live to a ripe old age until 1988. Initially a member of Lala Lajpat Rai's Lok Sewak Mandal (the 'Servants Of The People Society'), a non-profit organization dedicated to the service of the people, he started teaching English at the National College in 1924. He too was responsible for a number of seditious publications. These included works bearing such provocative names as *Bharat Mata Keh Darshan* ('Let us meet our Motherland') and *Nauzawanon se do do baten* ('A Conversation with the Youth'), not to mention *Chingarian* ('Fireworks'), which was by far his most popular with the young men in his college right up until Independence.

These were incendiary writings, but they did him no harm, as a year later in 1925 he was appointed principal. Bhagat Singh held him in high esteem and often spoke to him privately. Chhabil Das himself recalls how 'I had good relations with him'. These were to such an extent that 'when Bhagat Singh heard that I was going to be married, he insisted that I should not marry'.[11] It was not because Bhagat Singh himself was free from fleeting